problem:

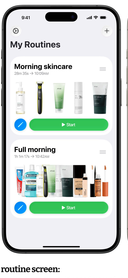
many people's daily routines involve dozens of products across skin-care, hair-care, and makeup. with so many steps, these routines become overwhelming, overly time consuming, and difficult to stick to.

solution:

routinely is a native ios app that uses hierarchy and visual feedback in your periphery to make complex personal care routines easier to follow. whether its shaving or skincare or haircare or makeup, routinely was designed to guide you step by step (and even sub-step by sub-step) through your morning routine.

my routines and new routine screen :

this is your list of existing routines aka the home-screen for the app, and the screen to create a new routine. lets say you would like to create a morning skincare routine; you simply press the plus button to create your routine, and then give it a name like "morning routine", next for your first step you can add a photo of your product, like your facial cleanser, and then you name it. then you add sub-steps like "apply, massage, and rinse" for example and how long these each take to do. once you have added all steps and sub-steps, you press the check button and it opens up the main routine view. when you open your app in the future after you have created at least 1 routine, you can see how long it will take to complete and when you will be finished if you start now.



routine screen:

this is where you would spend most of your time while using the app. the primary element is the photo of the product photo you added with the background removed, since this will be more quickly recognizable than any product name. below it is the step carousel, it is placed below the step image/product photo so that you know that when you scroll to the side you are flipping through products, but you can actually scroll side to side from any point in the screen. below that is the current step and sub-step. you are given a timer for your current sub-step, the largest text in the interface since it is the text that you will spend the most time reading. the next sub-step, sub-step progress bars, step completion time, and routine completion time are there as well, but smaller since these have less priority so that your eye is drawn to the sub-step timer first. finally are the pause routine and end routine buttons. these are placed at the bottom so that they are as reachable as possible with one hand.

step finished and routine paused screens:

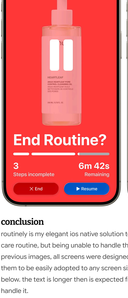
these are the screen you see when you finish a step, and the screen you see when you press the pause button. when these appear, the background for the screen changes as you can see. the purpose of these is for the change to be visible even from your peripheral vision. this is something that i learned from apple's design resources, specifically a video on how to design for spatial interaction. "the type size we use for the distance when finding an airtag is set much larger than in other parts of the system... bold color changes can be read in my periphery... without ever having to look at the screen. this ultimately supports a more natural pose as i use it." when using precision finding to find an airtag with iphone, the screen background turns green when the arrow locks onto the device. this allows the user to walk towards the airtag within their setting and get updates from their peripheral vision, not be forced to look at their iphone the entire time.

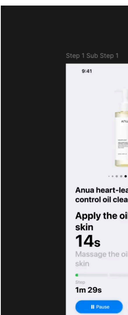
my intention is similar to apple's. when you complete a step, even if you are currently looking at your bathroom mirror, the screen turns green so that from your periphery you can know that you have completed your step and can move onto the next. the same applies to the routine paused screen, it is blue so that if you accidentally press the pause button, or some water droplets from your sink do, you will know. in the same place that you would pause your routine, the resume button replaces it. in addition, the interface changes to reflect only that the routine is paused, and how much of the routine is left, rather than continuing to show the step information.

end routine and routine finished screens

the end routine is the same concept as the pause routine. it is a confirmation screen with a red background, just in case you press it on accident. however, the button placements switch since if it was an accident, you are more likely to accidentally press that spot twice then press the right button then the left button accidentally. this also gives the user a chance to make sure that ending the routine is what they want.

the routine finished screen is somewhat similar to the step finished screen. it is green to let you know that the routine is complete from your periphery. from this screen you can choose to press a button that sends you a notification later in the day that reminds you to recharge or restock your product (buy a new one). in addition, the app encourages routine consistency with a streak of days you have done the routine in a row, total days you have done the routine total, and time spent doing it total. i believe that routinely should encourage you to be consistent with your personal care routines, since commitment to these is something people struggle with.



conclusion

routinely is my elegant ios native solution to wanting to commit to a long personal care routine, but being unable to handle the complexity. while not shown in the previous images, all screens were designed using figma auto layout, allowing them to be easily adopted to any screen size with little work, as you can see below. the text is longer then is expected from users to show the apps ability to handle it.